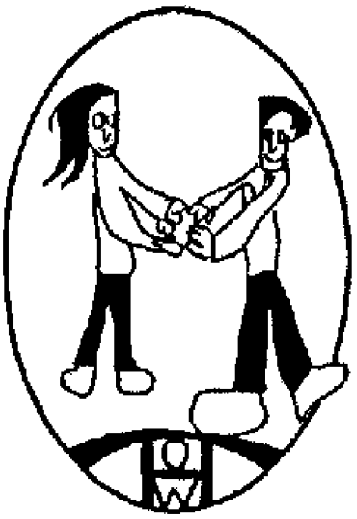
Howbridge Infant School



Charging, Refunds and Remissions Policy

July 2026

CHARGING POLICY

The school aims to have a clear, robust process in place for charging, refunds, and remissions; this policy clearly sets out the activities that are chargeable, when charges will and will not be made, the management of refunds and the process for claiming remission.

The governing body has overall responsibility for approving and monitoring the implementation of this policy.

The headteacher is responsible for ensuring all staff are familiar with the content of this policy and that it is being applied consistently.

Staff are responsible for implementing this policy and notifying the headteacher of any specific circumstances where they are unsure of that implementation.

Definitions
Charge: the fee payable for a specifically defined activity
Refund: the return of monies previously paid for a specifically defined activity
Remission: the cancellation of / exemption from a charge that would normally be payable

School Meals

There is no charge for pupils for school meals as all children in the school are entitled to universal infant free school meals.

Educational Visits

The school will seek voluntary contributions from parents/carers where applicable.

The school will not exclude a child from participating in an activity during the school day on financial grounds.

Where 10% or more of parents decline to make the requested voluntary contribution (their identity will remain confidential and will not be discriminated against), it will be at the Headteacher's discretion whether the visit will take place.

Residential Trips

At present Howbridge Infant School does not organise residential trips.

Examination Fees

At present there are no examination fees.

Music Tuition

Instrumental tuition or singing lessons do not form part of the curriculum but may be an additional activity arranged by the school and delivered by specialist tutors either on an individual basis or as part of a group, following parental request. The cost of such lessons is dependent on the charges applied by the tutors, the size of the group, the duration and frequency of each lesson.

All fees are payable to the music tuition provider.

However, in order to ensure equal opportunities for all pupils, charges for music tuition within school hours for pupils eligible for free school meals or children in care will be considered for remission. This is determined by the music provider and parents would need to apply directly to the provider.

There will be no charge applied if the music tuition forms part of a public examination syllabus being followed by a pupil of the school.

Extra Curricular Activities

Where these activities run outside of normal school hours, (i.e. sports clubs, homework club, art club) a charge may be made to cover costs of equipment, teaching or non-teaching staff, specialist staff /coaches or materials used. The total charge will not exceed the actual costs incurred in the provision of the activity and will be set by the Headteacher.

Parents/carers will be advised of any such costs before their child is allowed to undertake any such activity and participation will be on the basis of the parent's willingness to pay the charges.

Parents/carers are able to claim remission from such charges in accordance with the guidance below.

Before and After School Club

Charges apply in accordance with the terms and conditions for the Club as distributed to parents when their child begins attendance at the Club.

Other Charges

The school may make a charge to cover the costs of other areas:

- books and materials belonging to the school that a pupil has lost
- books and materials that a parent wishes a pupil to keep after having been advised of the cost
- activities taking place outside school hours that are not:
    - part of the school's curriculum
    - part of a syllabus for a public examination that the pupil is being prepared for by the school
    - part of the school's basic religious education

- property damage - each individual case to be decided upon by the Headteacher
    - full repair costs incurred as a result of wilful or reckless damage to school property by a pupil or parent/carer
    - full recovery of costs incurred by the school as a result of damage caused by a pupil to a third party property.
- materials/ingredients for subjects such-as design or food technology where the parents have indicated in advance that they would like their child to bring home the finished product.

Clothing

Although no charge will be made for "equipment" for use in school in connection with education provided during school hours, clothing is specifically excluded from the definition of equipment. Parents will therefore be asked to provide their children with such things as PE kit, protective aprons and sports kit.

No Charge Applies

- for activities taking place during school hours except any of those listed above
- for transport during school hours for school-organised activities except for educational visits as detailed above
- for activities outside school hours that are part of the
    - set curriculum including sports matches against other schools / academies
    - syllabus for a public examination that the pupil is being prepared for by the school
    - school's basic religious education syllabus
- for admissions.

Voluntary Contributions

The school may, from time to time, ask parents/carers for voluntary contributions to the school's general funds in order to assist with the provision of resources to enhance their children's education. There will be no pressure exerted and any contribution will be gratefully received.

Where the voluntary contribution applies to an educational visit or extra-curricular activity, if the sufficient level of contributions is not achieved, that activity may be cancelled; any monies already collected will be refunded to the relevant parents/carers.

DBS Checks

The school will cover the cost of DBS checks for all employed staff and volunteers.

Difficulty in Making a Financial Contribution

Parents who are in receipt of specific benefits may be entitled to additional support when being asked for contributions. Parents should contact the school office or the class teacher if they are unable or unwilling to pay.

Freedom of Information/Data Protection Requests

Individuals can request to see what information the school holds about them. This is known as a Subject Access Request. Whilst we will provide most information free of charge, we may charge a fee for photocopying/printing/faxing/postage of longer documents. If you ask for information in an expensive alternative format, we may charge for this.

REFUNDS POLICY

Educational visits

- When a pupil is absent due to illness and does not attend an educational visit, the transport/entrance cost will not be refunded, where already committed. However, where possible, the school will endeavour to recover costs related to that activity and, if successful, will then refund the parent/carer.
- If a trip has to be cancelled by the school, parental contributions will be refunded, less any initial deposits withheld by the venue.
- Where contributions for an activity exceed the final total cost by more than £5 per pupil, a refund will be given. Excess income less than £5 per pupil will be retained in school funds. Excess expenditure will be paid from school funds.

Music Tuition

Where Instrumental or singing lessons are cancelled by the tutor or the school, and payment has already been received, the tuition provider will transfer the funds to cover future lessons taken by the relevant pupil. If lessons are not being continued in the following term, the parent/carer may request a refund. Where a pupil fails to attend a pre-booked lesson, refunds do not apply.

Extra-curricular activities

- If a pupil does not attend an activity due to illness, no refund applies.
- Where curriculum related clubs are cancelled by the school, the income received will be held to cover the cost of the next round. Where pupils are not taking part in the future, parents/carers are entitled to request a refund.

Outside of school hours activities - not part of the curriculum, or public examination syllabus or part of the school's basic religious education

- If a pupil does not attend an activity due to illness, no refund applies.

- Where the activity is cancelled by the school, the income received will be held to cover the cost of the next round. Where pupils are not taking part in the future, parents/carers are entitled to request a refund.
- Where the activity is arranged by the school but has been cancelled by external organisers/tutors/sports coaches, the school will endeavour to obtain refunds which, upon receipt, will be passed onto the parents/carers.
- Where an activity arranged by external organisers directly with parents/carers is cancelled, the parents/carers must contact the organisers to obtain a refund in accordance with the separate booking agreement.

Breakfast and After School Clubs

Refunds are in accordance with the rules laid down in the separate Breakfast / After School Club terms and conditions.

REMISSIONS POLICY

The Headteacher and Chair of Governors will authorise the remission of charges in all cases.

The school will consider the remission of charges to parents or carers who receive the relevant support payments (in accordance with the current DfE listing) which make their child/children eligible for free school meals and for children in care.

All claims for remission of charges should be addressed to the Headteacher and will be dealt with confidentially.

The school may decide to subsidise part or all of the payment of some charges for certain activities and pupils; each event or case will be considered individually by the Headteacher and the governing body.